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Patrick A. Testa

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Research

Applied microeconomics, migration, demography, economic history, political economy.

Education

University of California, Irvine, Irvine, CA
- Ph.D., Economics 2019
  - Dissertation: *Essays in the Political Economy of Development*
  - Committee: Stergios Skaperdas, Daniel Bogart, and Jean-Paul Carvalho
- M.A., Economics 2015

Loyola University, New Orleans, LA
- B.B.A., Economics 2014

Employment

Tulane University, New Orleans, LA
- Associate Professor of Economics (with tenure) 2026–Present
- Faculty Affiliate, Murphy Institute 2019–Present
- Assistant Professor of Economics 2019–2026
- Kurzius Family Early Career Professor of Economics 2022–2023

National Bureau of Economic Research, Cambridge, MA
- Faculty Research Fellow 2025–Present

Articles, Peer Reviewed

1. "The Confederate Diaspora" (with Samuel Bazzi, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson), **Forthcoming** at the ***Review of Economic Studies***.

   Featured in: VoxEU, USA Today, NBC News, LSE Ballpark, Marginal Revolution, 94.1 KPFA.
2. "State Capacity and Identity: Assimilation vs Resistance of Tribal Rimlands," 2026, ***European Economic Review***, 184, 1–13 (with Stergios Skaperdas).
3. "Political Foundations of Racial Violence in the Post-Reconstruction South," 2026, ***Quarterly Journal of Economics***, 141, 733–49 (with Jhacova Williams).
4. "National Identity, Public Goods, and Modern Economic Development," 2025, ***Journal of Comparative Economics***, 53, 412–32 (with Stergios Skaperdas).
5. "New Area- and Population-based Geographic Crosswalks for U.S. Counties and Congressional Districts, 1790–2020," 2024, ***Historical Methods***, 57, 67–79 (with Andreas Ferrara and Liyang Zhou).
6. "Churches as Social Insurance: Oil Risk and Religion in the U.S. South," 2023, ***Journal of Economic History***, 83, 786–832 (with Andreas Ferrara).
7. "The Other Great Migration: Southern Whites and the New Right," 2023, ***Quarterly Journal of Economics***, 138, 1577–1647 (with Samuel Bazzi, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson).

   Featured in: NPR, The Washington Post, The Economist, Boston Globe, VoxTalks.
8. "The Economic Legacy of Expulsion: Lessons from Post-war Czechoslovakia," 2021, ***The Economic Journal***, 131, 2233–71.

   Featured in: *The Economic Journal*'s "Economics of Conflict" Compilation.
9. "Shocks and the Spatial Distribution of Economic Activity: The Role of Institutions," 2021, ***Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization***, 183, 791–810.
10. "Education and Propaganda: Tradeoffs to Public Education Provision in Nondemocracies," 2018, ***Journal of Public Economics***, 160, 66–81.

Articles, Non-Peer Reviewed

11. "Sundown Towns and Racial Exclusion: The Southern White Diaspora and the 'Great Retreat'," 2022, ***American Economic Association: Papers and Proceedings***, 112, 234–8 (with Samuel Bazzi, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson).

Works In Progress

12. "The Winner Premium."
13. "The Geography of Demographic Composition in the United States" (with Samuel Bazzi, Eric Chyn, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson).

    Funded by the National Science Foundation, Russell Sage Foundation, and CAIDS.
14. "The Economic Effects of the 1878 Yellow Fever Epidemic" (with Grace Alster, Samuel Bazzi, and Joshua Graff Zivin).
15. "Jazz" (with Andreas Ferrara, Stephan Heblich, and Joshua Graff Zivin).

Presentations, Since 2019

2026: Department Seminar at UN Lincoln (Lincoln, NE), Economic History Seminar at Northwestern (Evanston, IL), Theory, History, and Development Seminar (UCI, Irvine, CA), Department Seminar at Vanderbilt (Nashville, TN), NBER Development of the American Economy Spring Meeting (Cambridge, MA), Economics Lunch Seminar (Tulane, New Orleans, LA), Loyola Economics Club (New Orleans, LA), Ohio University George Washington Forum (New Orleans, LA).

2025: Department Seminar at Ole Miss (Oxford, MS), Department Seminar at UTEP (El Paso, TX, invited but could not attend).

2024: ASSA Meeting (San Antonio, TX), MWEH Conference (Utah State, Logan, UT), ASREC 2024 (Chapman, Orange, CA), EHA Annual Meeting (Sacramento, CA), Department Seminar at UC Merced (Merced, CA, cancelled), Trade and Development Seminar at Boston University (Boston, MA), 94th SEA Meeting (Washington, DC).

2023: Economics Lunch Seminar (Tulane, New Orleans, LA).

2022: Osaka University (virtual), Economics Lunch Seminar (Tulane, New Orleans, LA), University of Pittsburgh (Pittsburgh, PA), ASREC 2022 (Chapman, Orange, CA).

2021: ASSA Meeting (virtual), THPE Reunion Workshop (virtual), 91st SEA Meeting (Houston, TX).

2020: 19th ASREC Meeting* (Chapman, Orange, CA), 95th WEAI Meeting* (Denver), LSU-Tulane Mini-Conference (virtual), Theory, History, and Development Seminar at UCI (virtual), ASREC 24h (virtual), Historical Political Economy Session at the 90th SEA Meeting* (New Orleans, LA), Economic Growth Conference at the 90th SEA Meeting (virtual). **cancelled due to the COVID-19 pandemic.*

2019: Tulane University (New Orleans, LA), Louisiana State University (Baton Rouge, LA), University of Utah (Salt Lake City, UT), George Mason University (Fairfax, VA), University of Alberta (Edmonton, CA).

Courses Taught

Tulane University

ECON 7510: Advanced Price Theory I (Ph.D. level).
ECON 3420: Economic History of the U.S.
ECON 4610/6610: Game Theory.
ECON 4410/6410: Mathematical Economics.
PECN 6000: Political Economy in Historical Perspective.
PECN 6000: Political Economy of Nondemocracy.
PECN 3010: Positive Political Economy.

Advising

Tulane University

- Ph.D. Dissertation: Lucia Kovacikova (2022, Marquette University), Gabe Olivier (2026, Florida State University), Alejandro Gonzalez Tapia (expected 2028), Nan Zhang (expected 2028).
- Undergraduate Honors Thesis: Grace Slapak* (2021), Mary-Crescent Carter* (2022), Ellie Stevenson (2025), Mika Nijhawan* (2025), Hope Breslin (2026), Scarlett Seyler* (2026), Aiyana Brumley* (2026), Kloe Godard (2027).
- Undergraduate Independent Studies: Benjamin Ferrell (2026), Georgia May (2026), Kenneth Munroe (2026).
- Major Advising: 19 current major advisees, with 41 total between 2019 and 2025.

**chaired or co-chaired.*

University Service

Tulane University

• Co-organizer, Center for Law & the Economy Public Colloquium	2026
• Navigating tenure (with Elliott Isaac), Economics junior faculty meeting	2026
• Faculty advisor and speaker, Summer Research Program	2025
• Co-organizer, Economics Seminar Series	2024–2025
• Creator, Economics "internships and careers" monthly email blast	Since 2022
• Hiring committee member, Economics-Murphy joint hire	2022
• Organizer, Economics Lunch Seminar Series	2021–2023
• Creator (with LaPorchia Collins), Economics internships and careers page	2021
• Faculty board member, Tulane Journal of Policy & Political Economy	Since 2020
• Exam coordinator (with Wei Long), Economics Ph.D. qualifying exams	Since 2020
• Interviewer, Murphy Institute director search	2020
• Mock interviewer, Economics job market candidates	Since 2019

Refereeing

American Economic Review, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *Czech Science Foundation*, *Economics of Governance*, *Economic Inquiry*, *Economic Journal*, *European Economic Review*, *Explorations in Economic History*, *Independent Review*, *Moravian Geographical Reports*, *Journal of Comparative Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, *Journal of Economic History*, *Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Population Economics*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of Regional Science*, *Public Choice*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Tulane Journal of Policy and Political Economy*.

Conference Service

Session Chair

2024: 9th SEA Meeting (Washington, DC)
2023: ASSA Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA)

Discussant

2024: ASSA Annual Meeting (San Antonio, TX)
2023: ASSA Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA)
2022: Economic History Association Meeting (La Crosse, WI)
2021: Economic History Association Meeting (Tucson, AZ)
2019: Economic History Association Meeting (Atlanta, GA)
2018: Urban Economics Association Meeting (Colombia, New York, NY)
2018: IRES Workshop (Chapman, Orange, CA)
2018: 17th ASREC Meeting (Chapman, Orange, CA)
2017: Public Choice Society Meeting (New Orleans, LA)
2017: 16th ASREC Meeting (Boston, MA)

Other Professional Service

Data

- County-to-county and county-to-CD crosswalks, 1790–2020: DOI. Featured on Best of #EconTwitter (Oct. 24, 2021).

Teaching

- Teaching material for geographic crosswalks: DOI.

Grants and Awards

Tulane University

- Data, AI, and Community Research Grant ($2,500), *CAIDS* 2025
- NSF Research Grant ($353,568), *National Science Foundation* 2025–2027
  Funding "The Geography of Demographic Composition in the United States" (with Samuel Bazzi, Eric Chyn, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson)
- Schloss Prize ($2,500), *Department of Economics* 2022, 2024
- RSF Research Grant ($195,022), *Russell Sage Foundation* 2024–2026
  "The Geography of Race and Ethnicity in the United States: Uncovering a Hidden History of Expulsion and Exclusion" (with Samuel Bazzi, Eric Chyn, Andreas Ferrara, Martin Fiszbein, and Thomas Pearson)
- Carol Lavin Bernick Faculty Grant ($7,000), *Tulane University* 2023–2024
- Kurzius Family Early Career Professorship ($6,500), *School of Liberal Arts* 2022–2023

University of California, Irvine

- Romney Award for Outstanding Research Paper, *School of Social Sciences* 2019
- Kassouf Fellowship for Excellence in Research, *Department of Economics* 2018
- Christian Werner Fellowship, *School of Social Sciences* 2018
- Student Fellowship Award, *Public Choice Society* 2017
- Art DeVany Best Poster Award, *Department of Economics* 2016
- Economics Merit Fellowship, *Department of Economics* 2016, 2018
- Summer Research Fellowship, *Department of Economics* 2016–2018
- Distinction in Microeconomics, *Department of Economics* 2015
- Humane Studies Fellowship, *Institute for Humane Studies* 2014–2018
- Merit Fellowship in Economics, *Department of Economics* 2014–2019